

INTELLIGENCE BRIEF / N° 153 · HOT

OLIX Computing

AI Semiconductors · Optical Inference Silicon · London (registered St Albans; founded 2024) · Private (\$3.3B; \$312M Series B, Aug 2026)

OLIX, the London AI-chip company founded in 2024 by James Dacombe, announced a \$312M Series B at a \$3.3B valuation on 3 August, tripling the \$1B mark set by its \$220M Series A in February. Arm, Hudson River Trading and Reed Hastings joined; the UK's Sovereign AI fund invested.

70

OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

HOT

SERIES

F1

RECOMMENDED TEAM

Atlassian
Williams Racing

ACTION HORIZON

6-10 WKS

THE CASE

Fundomo led the round; Arm, Hudson River Trading and Reed Hastings joined, and existing backers Hummingbird, Plural, Creandum, Crane, Phoenix Court and Transition increased their commitments. Six months earlier Hummingbird had led a \$220M Series A at just over \$1B. Olix builds specialised inference silicon connected by an optical network, with first systems due to customers in the second half of 2027. It is recruiting engineers across London, Bristol, Austin, Toronto and San Francisco, has hired former Wise CFO Matt Briers as CFO and put Stanford's Nick McKeown on the board.

The grid has already priced AI silicon: Groq became an Official Partner of McLaren in September 2025 with its inference chips on the car from Singapore, and Arm, now an Olix investor, sits on Aston Martin Aramco's roster. Olix is the British entrant without a seat. A company that must recruit against Nvidia and sell to hyperscalers before its first chip ships has a brand to build, and now the money to build it.

WHY NOW

The round closed on 3 August and the first systems ship in the second half of 2027, so a three-season deal from 2027 straddles launch. Teams settle 2027 rosters in the fourth quarter, and the United States GP in Austin, where Olix is hiring, falls in late October.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

\$312M

\$312M Series B at a \$3.3B valuation announced 3 Aug 2026, led by Fundomo; follows a \$220M Series A at just...

\$220M

Six months earlier Hummingbird had led a \$220M Series A at just over \$1B.

GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE F1 GRID (SPONSOR TABLE; 49 OF 346 PARTNER ROWS CATEGORISED)

Atlassian Williams Racing	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
◆ RECOMMENDED		
Mercedes-AMG Petronas F1 Team	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Oracle Red Bull Racing	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Scuderia Ferrari HP	OPEN	no rival in this category lane

BOTTOM LINE

\$312M at \$3.3B, a government-backed sovereign-AI story and an open silicon lane at a British team make Olix a 2027 partner to sign in the fourth quarter. The pre-product timeline and the absence of a marketing owner hold the score at 70.

WHY ATLASSIAN WILLIAMS RACING

Williams runs a data-native roster: Atlassian as title partner, VAST for the data platform, Keeper for identity, Airia and Brillio, and Claude as Official Thinking Partner. It carries no semiconductor or AI-compute partner, so Official AI Silicon Partner is a clean category. Grove is a British engineering revival to match a British chip champion, and the team's own arc, a rebuilt technical base chasing far larger incumbents, is OLIX's arc.

VALUE TO ATLASSIAN WILLIAMS RACING — MODE B (TECH SERVES THE TEAM OPERATION)

MODE B - halo with concrete mechanics. OLIX has nothing to deploy before the second half of 2027, so year one is brand and talent: the Williams engineering-recruitment platform for a company hiring in five cities; sovereign-AI storytelling with government backing at Silverstone; Austin hospitality for hyperscaler and capital-markets buyers. From 2027, a defined evaluation of OLIX inference systems on Williams' machine-learning workloads, as an early reference deployment.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Entry as Official AI Silicon Partner. **THREE YEARS**, 2027-2029, bridging first shipments and a probable listing. Estimated \$3-5M a year, stepping up with product delivery; a technical-evaluation clause from 2027. Scope: sidepod or halo placement, engineering-recruitment content, British and United States GP hospitality, an early-access reference programme.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

James Dacombe

FOUNDER & CEO, OLIX COMPUTING · VERIFIED

Dacombe founded OLIX in 2024 and has fronted both raises, \$220M and \$312M, six months apart; a first sports partnership is his call. Path: Tom Elvidge, COO (reported), and Matt Briers, CFO, who took Wise through its 2021 London direct listing. No chief marketing officer is listed.

OPENING ANGLE

Lead with Groq and the open lane.

“James, Groq took its seat at McLaren before its chips mattered on track. Williams has no silicon partner and a British engineering story that reads as yours. 25 minutes before Austin to see what a 2027 start looks like?”

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 17 / 20 Round announced 3 Aug; Q4 roster window and Austin inside the horizon.	CAPACITY 15 / 20 \$312M at \$3.3B, but cash earmarked for silicon and supply chain.	BRAND FIT 14 / 20 Deep-tech British champion; B2B audience is hyperscalers and talent.	URGENCY 11 / 20 No hard deadline; product lands H2 2027, so 2027 start is the hook.	OPS FIT 13 / 20 MODE B until 2027; open silicon lane at Williams.
--	--	---	--	--

RISKS & COUNTERS

PRE-PRODUCT No systems ship before the second half of 2027 and the raise is committed to manufacturing and supply-chain obligations. **Counter:** Structure fees to step up with delivery and lead with the talent and sovereign-AI story, which needs no product.

NO MARKETING OWNER No chief marketing officer is listed; the founder fronts every announcement and a first sponsorship is his call alone. **Counter:** Route the commercial case through CFO Matt Briers, who ran a public-market brand story at Wise.

SOURCES — 13 OF 13 LOAD-BEARING CLAIMS VERIFIED

- https://find-and-update.company-information.service.gov.uk/company/15585099/officers
- https://olix.com/news/company-raises-series-b
- https://www.mclaren.com/racing/partners/groq/mclaren-racing-announces-groq-as-an-official-partner/
- https://www.datacenterdynamics.com/en/news/chip-startup-olix-raises-312m-at-33bn-valuation-backed-by-uk-govt-sovereign-ai-venture-fund/
- https://siliconangle.com/2026/02/11/photonic-ai-chip-startup-olix-nabs-220m-investment/